

Fish for food

All over the world, fish is an important part of people's diets. It contains protein, vitamins, and minerals. Fish can be cooked in many different ways or even eaten raw.

WHO EATS THE MOST FISH?

These ten countries eat more fish per person per year than anywhere else in the world.

- 1 MALDIVES**
154 kg (339.5 lb) Favourites: skipjack tuna, yellowfin tuna, and mahi-mahi.
- 2 ICELAND**
94 kg (207.2 lb) Favourites: haddock, halibut, herring, and plaice.
- 3 KIRIBATI**
76.3 kg (168 lb) Favourites: lobster, yellowfin tuna, and skipjack tuna.
- 4 GUYANA**
73 kg (161 lb) Favourites: crab, tilapia, and catfish.
- 5 JAPAN**
71.9 kg (158.5 lb) Favourites: bluefin tuna, salmon, prawns, and eel.
- 6 FRENCH POLYNESIA**
67.5 kg (149 lb) Favourites: tuna, mahi-mahi, octopus, sea urchin, and prawns.
- 7 SEYCHELLES**
62.3 kg (137 lb) Favourites: octopus, tuna, squid, red snapper, and grouper.
- 8 NORWAY**
61.9 kg (136.4 lb) Favourites: smoked salmon, prawns, trout, crab, cod, and herring.
- 9 PORTUGAL**
58.7 kg (129.4 lb) Favourites: cod, sardines, octopus, squid, crab, lobster, clams, mussels, and oysters.
- 10 MALAYSIA**
54.2 kg (119.4 lb) Favourites: prawns, crab, squid, cuttlefish, octopus, and sea cucumbers.

SUSHI AND SASHIMI

Raw fish is often used in Japanese dishes. Nigiri sushi uses rice formed into a rectangle with fish placed on top. Sashimi is very fresh, sliced raw fish. Maki sushi rolls are wrapped in seaweed called nori.



NIGIRI SUSHI



SASHIMI



MAKI SUSHI ROLLS

SALTED FISH, DRIED FISH

Fish does not stay fresh for long, particularly if it cannot be refrigerated. So fish is often preserved in salt or brine (very salty water), or dried to use later.



SMOKED FISH

Fish can also be preserved by smoking in one of two ways. Hot-smoked fish are brined, dried, and then smoked quickly. Cold-smoked fish are brined and then smoked for 1–5 days.



ROUND FISH

Round fish have cylindrical bodies, making it possible to fillet (cut) pieces from both sides of their bodies. Depending on their texture, they are known as either white fish or oily fish.

